personal cathedrals (even diamonds here don't shine)

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by wronghuntress

Summary

"Since when do you help princesses?" Adora snickered.

"Since I got something out of it."

"Oh? And what are you getting from me?"

Catra just smirked, tossing a black suit jacket into Adora's arms, "Don't we have somewhere to be?"

Adora pulled the jacket on, feeling slightly more at ease with the extra coverage, "Fine, we'll circle back to this later."

"No, we won't."

"Damnit."

or

Horde Lord Adora receives an invitation to the all princess ball and decides it might just be the opportunity she'd been waiting for. Will they find common ground with the Rebellion? Will they help bring Etheria to peace? And most importantly, will catra and adora EVER stop flirting?

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

The day started out normal.

Well, as normal as it could get in the Horde. Adora was lounging on Hordak's old throne, going through the many files left behind when he'd gotten his involuntary demotion from their leader to their prisoner.

Not for the first time since that day - which had only been a few short months ago - Adora wondered how he'd managed to keep the place running with his frankly abysmal leadership skills.

The cadets scores in training were getting worse by the day and the overall morale of what had once been her peers had been at an all time low before Adora's acquisition.

It had been her first act as 'Horde Lord' to correct those mistakes. The clear neglect that Hordak had led his army with wasn't an easy thing to rectify. Above all else, Adora had to make the Fright Zone somewhat liveable - something her predecessor had never cared about. It was one of the many things that had led to his downfall.

Adora crumpled the paper in her hand, sighing deeply. This is what she'd been groomed for her entire life. It's what she suspects Shadow Weaver had spent all that time training her for. It was all for this. Surpass Hordak and let Adora take the reins while Shadow Weaver remained the power behind the throne, puppeteering Adora's every decision. Shadow Weaver couldn't stop at second in command. She *wouldn't.* - her hunger for power had been too great.

But where had that left her? In the cell opposite Hordak's. With her protégée on a throne she never asked for and never wanted.

Now, Adora was left with responsibilities that years of training could never prepare her for. Trapped in a war with people she didn't want to hurt. People who deep down Adora knew had every right to want to hurt *her* .

Soft footsteps padded against the metal floors, stirring Adora from her thoughts as the figure ascended the stairs and plopped on the armrest of the throne - a highly uncomfortable place to be, in Adora's opinion.

Still, a slow smile spread across her face. There was *one* good thing to come out of all this strife and Adora didn't plan to let go of her anytime soon.

"Hey, Adora," Catra purred, leaning over her to examine the files in her grasp, her long brown hair tickling Adora's nose as she did so - an action Adora felt was entirely intentional judging by Catra's attempt at an innocent smile.

"Awake before noon, Catra?" Adora couldn't help but tease, "I'm shocked."

Catra huffed, "I can't let you have all the fun, can I?" She scooped up a file, eyeing it critically, "if you can even call *this* fun."

"We have to get things in order if we want any chance at getting the Rebellion off our backs," Adora said seriously, taking the file back.

The Rebellion hadn't taken news of a new leader well, sending more spies to infiltrate the Fright Zone along with increased military presence in the villages formerly occupied by the Horde's own troops before Adora had ordered all of them to vacate.

Adora knew she wouldn't gain their trust right away - maybe not ever, but she'd hoped they might lower their guard if she proved not to be a threat. She hadn't taken into account that they'd take her lack of attacks as gearing up for something even worse.

Catra rolled her eyes, "I don't know why you bother. It's not like they'll ever give any of us a chance."

"You want this war to end, don't you?"

Catra sighed, looking away, “I want to keep you from getting yourself killed. I’m just not sure trying to negotiate with *princesses* will accomplish that.”

“We have to at least *try*- ”

“They won’t listen to you.”

“You don’t know that.”

“They’re *princesses*- ”

“Who have every right not to trust as after what the Horde did to them,” Adora reminded her.

Catra scoffed, “You can’t seriously be considering trusting princesses.”

“You trust me, don’t you?”

“That’s not-” Catra hesitated, shaking her head, “You’re not a-”

“Aren’t I?” Adora asked softly, eyes falling on the sword at her hip. The sword that had brought them here. The sword that started it all.

“You have a stupid tiara,” Catra acknowledged, glancing in her direction, “I suppose that’s a requirement.”

“And you still trust me?”

Catra sighed, “You know I do.”

“And…” Adora hesitated a moment,“You still love me?”

Catra closed her eyes, letting out another sigh - though Adora could see the slight quirk of her mouth as she fought a smile, “Unfortunately for me, yes.”

Adora grabbed her hand, guiding her to curl up on the throne next to her, “And I love you.”

Catra buried her face in Adora’s neck, but didn’t reply aside from a soft squeak.

“I’d never do anything if I thought you’d get hurt,” Adora continued firmly, squeezing her hand, “So, can you trust that *maybe* I know what I’m doing?”

“As if you’re not making this up as you go along-” Catra tried to snark, but let out a startled yelp when Adora poked her side.

“Are you with me or not?” She asked. The words were spoken lightly, but Adora couldn’t help the fear that flared inside her at the thought that maybe Catra wouldn’t agree. That she’d leave Adora to do it all on her own.

“I’m always with you,” Catra muttered into her neck, a rare moment of vulnerability that she only ever allowed Adora to see, “I just don’t want to see you get hurt.”

“I won’t,” Adora promised, “Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other, right?”

Catra peered up at her, eyes narrowing, “Okay, that’s *cheating* !”

Adora wrapped an arm around her girlfriend, plopping her head atop hers as a grin spread across her face, “Yeah, but it’s working isn’t it?”

“Fuck off.”

“I’ll take that as a yes.”

“I resent that.”

“You’ll get over it,” Adora replied cheekily.

They fell into comfortable silence, broken up only by the never ending sounds of machinery echoing through the halls of the Fright Zone. It was hard to imagine living without that noise, no matter the memories that came with it.

“Do you really think you can talk your way out of this?” Catra asked sometime later, a contemplative look on her face, “You said it yourself: they don’t trust us.”

“We just need to find a way to change that,” Adora insisted, trying to sound assured even as her own doubts crept in, “Then we can end this for good. And once we reach an agreement, we’ll run things better than Hordak ever did. Just like we said we would.”

“Something tells me they won’t be open to just letting us have control over the Horde.”

“I don’t think they’ll have a lot of options,” Adora hummed thoughtfully, “Princesses aren’t exactly gonna be jumping at the chance to deal with this place.”

“And Scorpia hasn’t exactly seemed thrilled at the thought of taking over,” Catra mused, “Funny, I didn’t think she was capable of not being thrilled about something.”

“Still, she’s a good ally,” Adora said, pulling Catra just a bit closer at the mention of the Horde’s princess.

Unfortunately for Adora, the action didn’t go unnoticed by her companion.

“You got a problem with her?” Catra smirked like she already knew the answer.

“Not at all, “Adora said breezily, avoiding her girlfriends eyes, “She’s nice. Gives pretty good hugs.”

It was impossible - even to herself - not to notice the way Adora bristled at her own words.

Catra hummed in agreement, “She does.”

Adora frowned petulantly.

“But you wanna know a secret?” Catra chirped, leaning in closer.

Adora gave her a questioning look, feeling her face heat at the proximity.

“You give better ones.”

Catra planted a chaste kiss to Adora’s lips, grinning at Adora’s flustered state

Adora cleared her throat, smiling, “O-Okay, we should probably get back to the files-”

“ *Boring* ,” Catra drawled, pressing a kiss to Adora’s cheek. Then another to her jaw. And once more to her lips.

“ *Catra-* ” Adora attempted to scold, but was cut off by another kiss that she found herself deepening moments later, clinging to Catra’s shirt to pull her ever closer.

Adora isn’t sure how long she stayed there, her mind hyper focused on all things *Catra* . The feeling of Catra’s lips against hers. The feeling of clawed hands running through her hair and up her back. The enthralling sensation of hair tickling her neck and the warmth spreading through her body as Catra nestled further into her lap. Just *Catra Catra Catra.*

Adora would have been content to stay that way for the rest of her life, but Catra seemed to be feeling especially bold, pulling her lips away and dropping them down to Adora’s neck. Adora’s breath grew heavy as Catra’s kisses trailed lower and lower, pausing to focus her attention on where her neck met her shoulder.

Adora’s eyes drooped close, losing herself in the sensation of it all. Forgotten files slid onto the floor, but Adora hardly noticed. Anything that wasn’t Catra was inconsequential at the moment - she couldn’t imagine thinking of anything else. Catra’s touch was pure bliss, it was all that mattered.

But as usual, something had to ruin the moment.

Someone cleared their throat and Adora’s eyes shot open as she scrambled to right herself. Catra let out an offended shriek as Adora attempted to put distance between them, but only succeeding in sending her gorgeous, amazing girlfriend sprawling to the floor at the foot of the throne.

Adora sent her an apologetic look, quickly refocusing her gaze on the new arrival and trying to maintain *some* of her dignity. However, she quickly recognized the interrupter and sank into her seat with a groan.

To absolutely no one’s surprise, it was all Kyle’s fault.

From the floor, Catra growled, " *Damnit, Kyle!"*

Kyle gulped, sending the pair an awkward wave, "Hey, guys!"

Catra pulled herself to her feet and plopped down onto Adora's lap almost petulantly, looking as pouty as one can manage while sitting in their girlfriends lap.

Adora waved back. Catra glared at her.

"Did you- uh, need something?" Adora ventured, raising an eyebrow at her old squad mate.

"Oh! Oh, uh- yes!" Kyle stepped forward, producing a rolled up parchment, "This arrived for you, Adora. It doesn't say who it's from."

Adora frowned, shifting Catra with her as she reached forward to take the parchment. She leaned back, cautiously unrolling the scroll and watching in awe as it unfurled, revealing pages worth of text with the end of the scroll brushing the ground beneath them.

"…Princess Prom?" Catra chortled, reading it much quicker than Adora, "What the fuck is this?"

"It looks like…an *invitation* ?" Adora replied in disbelief, scanning the scroll for something that would make sense of this situation.

Kyle's eyes widened, "The princesses are inviting you to their prom? Wow! That's- well… great! Uh…wh-what's a prom?"

"Bye, Kyle," Catra said pointedly.

“Bye!” He replied cheerfully, exiting quickly, “Have fun at the prom thingy!”

“This is definitely a trap, right?” Catra said once Kyle had gone, “I mean, it has to be.”

“I don’t know, it seems legit” Adora tilted her head thoughtfully, pointing at a particular line of text, “Look right here: it says there’ll be no fighting allowed at this thing. Not even weapons.”

“So? How do you know this is even *real* ? It’s probably some clever way to ambush you,” Catra fretted, looking unhappy at Adora’s contemplative expression, “Don’t tell me you’re *actually* thinking about going.”

“This is a *perfect* opportunity to find some common ground, Catra,” Adora told her excitedly, “I can talk to them - maybe even get them to agree to a negotiation!”

“Or you take one step inside this…” Catra paused to read, “ *Kingdom of Snows* and they kill you. It’s too dangerous, Adora.”

Adora shook her head, “We may never get a chance like this again. Besides, maybe this invite is an olive branch. Maybe it means they’re willing to hear us out!”

“And if you’re wrong?” Catra pressed, “You could get hurt. Or even worse - *killed* . You can't go alone. I won’t let you.”

“Not a problem,” Adora smiled, “I get a plus one. Which means *you* get to come with me.”

“I like this plan even less now.”

Adora rolled her eyes good-naturedly, “Cmon, Catra, it could be fun! Just you and me, we’ll dress up and do some reconnaissance! It’ll be like a date.”

Catra raised an eyebrow, “Do you even know what that is?”

“I’ve heard things,” Adora shrugged, “I dunno, couples do it?”

Catra blushed, “Well, when you put it like *that* ~”

“Is that a yes?”

“It’s a… *maybe.* ” Catra wheedled, “I still don’t trust this.”

Adora kissed her firmly, pulling away after a moment and cupping Catra’s face in her hands.

“Trust *me* ?” Adora offered, “This is the chance we’ve been waiting for. We *have* to try.”

Adora had spent her entire life believing in something that wasn’t real. Fighting for people whose only goal was to cause pain. It was something Adora would never go back to as long as she lived. She’d believed in the Horde’s cause once - at least, what she *thought* it was. Now, she had the chance to make it a reality. To make the Horde better for those who resided in the Fright Zone. To heal the wounds Hordak and Shadow Weaver had inflicted on Etheria.

It wouldn’t be easy. Adora didn’t expect it to be. But she wasn’t going to give up, not when she was this close. This “Princess Prom” could be her way in. The way to reach some type of understanding with those she’d once seen as enemies. The way to see the princesses somewhere other than the opposite end of a battlefield. To break the cycle. To end everyone’s suffering for good.

Catra studied her face. Adora didn’t bother hiding her fears or her doubts - Catra knew her better than anyone. She’d see right through it. Adora hoped Catra could also see the resolve

in her eyes. The determination to see this through, no matter how it ended.

Catra frowned, leaning into Adora's hand as it caressed her cheek, "This is really important to you, isn't it?"

Adora nodded, "I have to do this, Catra. I just need you to believe that I can."

"I believe in you," Catra said earnestly, "I believe you can do this. That's what scares me."

"Change isn't always a bad thing."

Catra's hand brushed against her cheek, her two-toned eyes staring into Adora's own as their foreheads brushed together.

Adora recalled a moment just like this - months ago, when Adora had found the sword. When it felt like everything might have even changing for the worst. A moment where Adora was certain that Catra wouldn't be able to accept this new part of her. That she'd lose the best thing that had ever happened to her - the only thing that kept her going. A moment where Catra had held her just like this and washed away her fears. A moment where - for the first time in Adora's life - she'd known that she was *wanted* .

Not just a puppet in someone else's bid for power. Not just a pawn in a chess game she never asked to play. Not just an idea someone else had of who she *should* be. The moment Catra had made her see that there *was* someone in this world that wanted her as she was. Not despite her flaws, but because of them. Because Catra loved *every* part of her - not just the parts deemed useful.

She could see it all again. *Feel* it all again as she looked into Catra's eyes and knew Catra was thinking of that same moment. That as far as they'd come - as much as things had changed in the past months - they were still just Catra and Adora. It was the one thing that would never change.

“No,” Catra smiled, “No, I suppose it’s not.”



“I told you to stop requesting me.”

Shadow Weaver didn’t respond immediately, making a show of sitting up against the cell wall as her restraints clacked against each other.

“Is that any way to speak to the woman who raised you?” Shadow Weaver tutted disappointingly.

“What do you want?” Adora continued, ignoring the blatant manipulation attempt. There was a time where she would have felt guilt at being so callous. A time where she would have fallen for Shadow Weaver’s honeyed words. Those times were long gone.

Shadow Weaver sighed, “I need your help, Adora.”

Adora scoffed, “Do you honestly expect me to help you after everything you did to me? After everything you did to *Catra* ?”

“I made you *strong* ,” Shadow Weaver hissed, “You’ve let her into your head, Adora. Can’t you see how Catra is using you-”

“The only one who’s ever tried to get into my head is *you* ,” Adora snarled, “I don’t owe you *anything!* And there is nothing you can say that would-”

“I’m dying, Adora.”

Adora stopped, eyes widening at the words. At first, she thought it must be some ploy. A trick to gain her trust or her sympathy. That is until she finally took a closer look at Shadow Weaver's form - She was hunched over, her breathing shallow. There was an aura of sickness surrounding her.

"All that dark magic is catching up to me now that my connection to the Garnet has been severed," Shadow Weaver continued, squinting almost accusingly at Adora, "But you can save me. The sword you wield - its magic could heal me. We could have a fresh start, you and I."

"And why would I want that?" Adora asked softly, "You've caused nothing but pain."

"You don't truly believe that, Adora," Shadow Weaver crooned, adopting a soft tone, "Was I not like a mother to you? Is it not because of me that you've excelled so far? You defeated Hordak because of *my* training. You are who you are because of me, Adora. Is that not worthy of some compensation?"

"You're right," Adora allowed, "You trained me to be a leader. And I am one. You trained me to succeed. And I did. But you also taught me to not trust anyone. To fear failure. To spend every day of my life trying to reach an impossible goal that would just keep changing every time I felt like I was close enough."

Shadow Weaver shifted uncomfortably, but Adora knew it had nothing to do with guilt and everything to do with the realization that Adora had no intention of helping her.

"You made me who I am," Adora continued, "And I have to live with that for the rest of my life, but I don't have to live with *you.* You are no longer my problem and if you think I'd ever even *consider* letting you near Catra ever again, then you don't know me as well as you think you do."

Shadow Weaver clenched her fist, her frustration clear even though Adora couldn't see her face.

"She has thoroughly corrupted you," Shadow Weaver spat.

“And I couldn’t be happier that she did,” Adora allowed a smile, “She got me away from you, after all.”

“You’ll regret this,” She warned, eyes narrowing through her mask, “Catra will only bring you down, Adora. She’s leeched off your talents for your whole lives. She will *ruin* you!”

“No, that’s what *you* do!” Adora growled, stepping closer to the barrier between them, “ *You* ruin people. You hurt them for your own sick gain! But not anymore. You’re *finished,* Shadow Weaver.”

“You will fail without me.”

Adora scoffed, shaking her head, “ *Goodbye* , Shadow Weaver.”

She moved to walk back down the corridor, turning her back on the sorceress. Adora heard the rattling of the restraints as Shadow Weaver attempted to scramble closer.

“You would just leave me to rot?” She demanded, “After *everything* I did for you?”

Adora didn’t look back, “I don’t care what you did for me. I’m leaving you to rot because of what you did to *Catra.* ”

Shadow Weaver made a desperate shuffle for the cell barrier, hissing out one last plea.

“I will *die* , Adora-”

“ *Good* ,” Adora interrupted coldly, turning her head back just slightly, to let Shadow Weaver see the rage simmering in her eyes, “I can't think of anyone that deserves it more than you.”

And with those parting words, Adora left Shadow Weaver to her misery.



Adora slipped into her quarters, frowning as she glanced at the clock on the bedside table. Shadow Weaver's begging had delayed her preparations for the ball. With a sigh, Adora shucked off her coat and shuffled around the room to find the dress she'd acquired for the event.

"What did Shadow Weaver want?"

Adora startled, turning to see Catra exiting the bathroom and throwing herself onto the bed to look at Adora with a raised eyebrow, holding herself up on her forearms.

Adora found herself unable to answer as she took in Catra's outfit. A dark red suit vest - cropped just enough for Adora to see a peek of her toned body - with matching pants and an assortment of gold jewelry adorning her hands and wrists. She looked *divine.*

Catra rolled her eyes, dropping her head back with an exasperated huff, which did nothing to help Adora's stupor as it gave her a delicious view of Catra's neck, long brown curls falling tantalizingly against her skin with the movement.

"You're so fucking hopeless."

Adora blinked, feeling heat rush to her face, "I am *not* ."

"You gonna answer the question then?" Catra asked casually, lifting her head to give Adora a knowing look.

"…question? Uh, well-," Adora racked her brain for a moment, cursing herself for getting so distracted. Catra would never let her hear the end of this.

Catra hummed affirmatively, beckoning Adora to continue with a flourish of her hand, "Yes?"

"Do you mind repeating it? I know already, obviously! I just wanna make sure *you* know it."

Catra snorted, letting herself fall fully against the mattress, "You're ridiculous."

Catra thrust out a hand, beckoning Adora over - she obliged, moving to sit next to her girlfriend on their bed.

"What did Shadow Weaver want?" Catra repeated slowly.

"Oh," Adora said, picking at her fingers, "She- she wanted my help."

Catra scoffed, "Of course."

Adora closed her eyes, deciding to just let it out. She knew Catra's feelings towards their guardian were just as complicated as her own and she hated to put Catra in any distress, but Adora knew that her girlfriend should know the truth of what Adora had been told by the sorceress.

"She's dying."

Catra froze next to her, "What are you talking about?"

“The consequences of dark magic are catching up to her,” Adora explained uncomfortably, “It’s killing her.”

“What does that have to do with you?” Catra responded, sounding slightly angry, though Adora wasn’t sure *who* she was angry at.

“She thinks I can use the sword to heal her.”

“And what did you say?”

“I basically told her to rot in hell,” Adora admitted, glancing over to gauge Catra’s reaction.

Catra sat up, beginning to pace the room. She didn’t give a response.

“Do you want me to do it?” Adora asked quietly after a moment.

“No,” Catra said quickly, stopping in her tracks, “No, I’m just-…I-” Catra trailed off, running a hand through her hair.

Adora waited patiently, offering out a hand to her girlfriend. Slowly, Catra walked closer, accepting the hand and standing in between her legs.

“…it feels wrong to be happy she’s dying,” Catra muttered finally.

“I know,” Adora ran her thumb along Catra’s hand, “At first, I wanted to believe she could change. But she never will. And I won’t risk her hurting you, Catra. Not again.”

“I can take care of myself,” Catra replied softly , resting their foreheads together.

“I don’t doubt that,” Adora smiled, “Doesn’t mean I’ll stop wanting to take care of you.”

“You’re such a sap, yknow?” Catra huffed, making a face of faux disgust.

Adora laughed, tugging her closer, “You *love* it.”

“Don’t be so sure.”

Adora pulled her into a kiss, humming contentedly against her lips.

Catra broke away after a moment, snickering at Adora’s pout, “You still need to get dressed for this stupid prom. Unless we’re ditching, after all?”

“ *Shit!”*

Adora scrambled over to where she’d set the dress, tugging it on and pointedly ignoring Catra’s laughter. After she pulled it on, she slid into the bathroom to fix her hair and grab the jewelry Scorpia had found for her to wear.

Once Adora had finished, she carefully placed a golden headpiece atop her head - it was a similar design to her tiara when she was in her She-Ra form, which was the intention. Adora didn’t know much about She-Ra, but she did know the crown would be a reminder of who she was. Something the people of Etheria respected. Hopefully, something they’d know better than to try and destroy.

Adora looked herself over in the mirror, feeling an odd mix of confidence and discomfort. The dress was black and gold with jewelry and draping fabric adorning the bodice and a high slit in the side revealing her thigh. Despite the showy-ness, Adora had to admit she looked *good* . She hoped Catra would think the same, admittedly having only agreed to such an elaborate choice in hopes of impressing her girlfriend.

She stepped out of the bathroom, leaning down to slip on a matching pair of heels (and hoping desperately she can manage to walk in them without falling) when she felt Catra's eyes trailing her across the room.

"See something you like, Catra?" Adora taunted, straightening back up and watching Catra's eyes darken even more.

"Do we really *have* to go to this stupid princess thing?" Catra purred, sauntering over and leaning into Adora, her tail brushing purposefully against Adora's forearm.

"It'll be fun," Adora assured, pressing her lips to the inside of Catra's wrist, "Think of it like a mission. Get in, gather information on where the princesses stand, get out."

"Can we steal their food?" Catra asked innocently, "I'm bored of ration bars."

"Of course we're stealing their food!" Adora said cheerfully, "I'm sure they have more."

" *Exactly* ," Catra agreed with a trill, "We'd really be helping them with the cleanup."

"Since when do you help princesses?" Adora snickered.

"Since I got something out of it."

"Oh? And what are you getting from me?"

Catra just smirked, tossing a black suit jacket into Adora's arms, "Don't we have somewhere to be?"

Adora pulled the jacket on, feeling slightly more at ease with the extra coverage, “Fine, we’ll circle back to this later.”

“No, we won’t.”

“ *Damnit* .”

Catra laughed, heading for the door. Adora followed suit, but paused as she passed the bed where her sword was laying.

Catra turned, leaning against the doorframe, “You coming?”

Adora scooped up the sword, concentrating all her energy into making it do what she wanted. Slowly, a bright glow spread across the weapon, replacing it with an innocuous bracelet that Adora slid onto her wrist.

“I thought the invite said no weapons,” Catra mused.

“It did,” Adora reached the door, linking their arms together, the blue gem of the bracelet flashing in the light, “They don’t have to know it’s there.”

Catra seemed pleased by the subtle deceit, squeezing Adora’s arm as they walked down the corridor to meet up with Scorpia - who’d be attending the ball alongside Lonnie for backup.

“Deceiving the princesses?” Catra hummed, “I like this side of you, Adora.”

“And what side would that be?”

“The one less inclined to trust blindly,” Catra replied bluntly, then nuzzled closer to Adora’s side - likely worrying her words were too harsh, “Not that it’s a bad thing. I just…I don’t-”

“You want to protect me,” Adora finished for her, “And I want to protect you. It’s easier to do that with some extra assurance.”

“I’m glad we agree on that, at least.”

“Don’t get too attached to the idea,” Adora joked, “We’ll end up in a debate before we even reach the Kingdom of Snows, I’m sure.”

“We both know I’ll end up winning,” Catra said, eyes narrowing competitively.

Adora chuckled, pressing a kiss into her hair.

“I never doubted that for a second, sweetheart.”



Glimmer leaned against the cold railing, glaring down at the figures gliding around the ballroom floor. She watched with building anger as Bow laughed loudly at something Perfuma said.

Glimmer clenched her fist. This was supposed to be *their* night. It was tradition, after all. They’d wear matching outfits and spend the night laughing at inside jokes and helping themselves to the buffet. All things that Bow had been doing all night with someone *else*.

She couldn’t believe that he’d chosen to go as Perfuma’s plus one, much less that he’d waited til the last second to even tell her about it. It hurt to think that he’d rather be with her than

Glimmer. They were *best* friends, weren't they? Glimmer thought that meant something to him. She wasn't so sure now.

Glimmer huffed, quickly wiping away the tears forming in her eyes and refocusing her gaze on the entrance. She just needed some air. She'd get herself together and third wheel on Mermista's not-date with Sea Hawk. She didn't *need* Bow-

All of Glimmer's thoughts suddenly came to a screeching halt. Four women dressed in formal clothing had entered the ballroom, their eyes roving over the decorations and mingling guests before settling on the throne across the room where Princess Frosta sat, watching the festivities.

One of the women was easily recognizable as Princess Scorpia - her family had allied themselves to the Horde years ago. As far as Glimmer was concerned, she was just as much an enemy as the rest of the Horde, regardless of any royal status she technically had.

Glimmer shuddered to think of how she'd gotten in, there was simply no way the Kingdom of Snows would *actually* invite Horde soldiers to the event.

She didn't recognize the other women, but Glimmer had heard plenty of rumors over the past months about new leadership in the Horde. Rumors of a legendary warrior resurfacing to fight alongside their *enemies* . One with flowing blonde hair and a magic sword.

There was no sword now, but Glimmer could almost *feel* the power radiating off the blonde woman - she was clearly the leader of the pack. And to Glimmer's horror, also technically a princess.

She watched as they slid into the crowd, blending in seamlessly as they made their way to the throne. Glimmer scrambled down the steps to where Bow was standing trading stories with his date.

" *Bow!"*

Bow turned to her with a smile, seeming almost relieved to see her, “Glimmer! I was wondering where you were! Perfume was just telling me this *hilarious*- ”

“The Horde’s here!” Glimmer burst out, almost glad for a reason to interrupt his raving about how great of a time he was having.

Bow’s face dropped, but Glimmer tugged him closer before he could reply and began dragging him along as she explained. They *had* to stop these soldiers before they could cause any mayhem.

Glimmer, focused as she was, couldn’t resist the annoyed scoff she let out as Bow fumbled along behind her, yelling out an apology to Perfuma. Wasn’t *this* more important than his precious date?

Frosta was mid-greeting when Glimmer reached them, pointing an accusatory finger at them as she pleaded to their host.

“Revered Hostess, you *can’t* let them in!” She said, glaring daggers at the women who had turned to her with expressions of surprise - and annoyance, in the case of the brunette magicat who didn’t even bother to hide an eye roll. “They’re from the *Horde!”*

“I told you,” The brunette mused, turning an amused expression towards the blonde at her side, who shushed her.

Frosta spoke up, eyes narrowed at Glimmer, “Princess Glimmer, the rules clearly state that *all* princesses are welcome - as are their chosen guests. Princess Scorpia and Princess Adora are honored guests and will be *treated* as such for the remainder of the ball.”

“Yeah,” the magicat woman drawled innocently, “didn’t you read the invite?”

“ *Catra* -” the blonde - Adora - scolded, though it bordered on a frustrated whine. Catra just snickered, interlocking her arm with Adora’s.

“Glimmer, maybe we should-” Bow began nervously, but Glimmer was too angry to give up now. Frosta was scolding *her* ? She was trying to help!

“But they’re up to something, I know it!” Glimmer cried, stepping forward, “You can’t let them-!”

“That’s *enough* !” Frosta stood from her throne and Glimmer face burned at the thought of being ridiculed by an *eleven year old,* “For centuries the All-Princess Ball has remained neutral ground and I will *not* dishonor that legacy by allowing you to pester the guests! They will *stay!* ”

Glimmer opened her mouth to argue, but Bow pulled her back as he eyed the guards at the foot of the throne.

“You *won’t* get away with this!” Glimmer snarled at the group, despite Bow’s protests. “I’ll figure out what you’re planning and I’ll *stop* you!”

“We aren’t *planning* anything,” Adora replied in a frustratingly polite voice, “We’re here for the Ball and nothing more.”

Catra smirked, practically hanging off Adora’s shoulder now, their fingers intertwined. “Yeah, *Sparkles* . So go bother someone else so we can enjoy ourselves.”

Glimmer’s retort, alongside Adora’s, was cut off as Bow let out a sudden “ *aww!”* , his eyes making hearts as he took in the closeness of the pair.

“Are you guys a couple?” He asked brightly, “That is *so* cute!”

“Bow, they are *horde soldiers!”*

“Love is love, Glimmer!”

The other woman - the only one Glimmer didn’t know the name of, let out a snort.

“They’re *insufferable* ,” She huffed, “I’ve had to watch them make eyes at each other since they were *six.”*

“ *Shut up, Lonnie!”* Catra squeaked, her face turning red - though she made no attempt to distance herself from her girlfriend.

“I think it’s sweet!” Scorpia cooed, her eyes mirroring Bow’s.

Lonnie rolled her eyes, “You *would* .”

“Can we focus, please?,” Adora chided, her ears pink. She turned to Catra, pointing an accusatory finger, “And you behave.”

Catra attempted to bite her finger. Glimmer figured that getting her to behave was a losing battle.

Glimmer crossed her arms angrily as Adora regarded her, trying to convey that this was *not* over. She’d follow them the whole night if that’s what it took.

“We don’t want any trouble,” Adora placated, “I was actually hoping to-”

“What? Get our guard down and ambush us?” Glimmer interrupted coldly, “You may have fooled Frosta but you won’t fool me.”

“I don’t want to fight,” Adora tried, though Glimmer could tell her patience was fading fast.

“Bullshit. You Horde soldiers *always* want to fight,” Glimmer growled, “Ever since you *started* this war-”

“ *I'm trying to end the war!”*

Glimmer froze at Adora’s outburst and even Bow halted his attempts to calm Glimmer as he turned his wide eyes on the Horde Lord.

Adora sighed, her frustration clear as day, “Neither of us want to be in this war, so why don’t we try working *together* for once instead of being at each other's throats?”

Glimmer hated that she wanted to say yes. It was too good to be true, she knew that. And she knew better than to ever trust a Horde Soldier, but it didn’t make the idea of a peaceful end to the war any less appealing.

“Work with the Horde?” Glimmer asked quietly, voice shaking with rage, “After what they’ve done? *Never* .”

And with that, Glimmer turned on her heel and stormed off, Bow following behind uncertainly, clearly worried about her.

She spared a glance back and felt something twist inside her as Adora’s face fell, hurt and defeat playing across her face.

Glimmer didn’t look back again.



“Well, that could’ve gone better.”

Adora gave no response to Catra's quip, even as she led them over to the buffet table - Scorpia and Lonnie disappearing out of the corner of her eye, probably to look around now that the princess was off their back.

"I mean, would it have *killed* her to actually listen to you for five seconds?" Catra scoffed as she scanned the plates for something appetizing.

When Adora remained silent, Catra turned to look at her and felt her heart clench at the disappointment in Adora's eyes. Catra cursed herself for being so cavalier about the situation - Adora was clearly upset and Catra was likely making it worse.

"Hey, it's okay," Catra said softly, touching her girlfriend's arm in what she hoped was a comforting manner, "We'll just let her cool off and try again. You'll win her over."

"I doubt it," Adora muttered, frowning at Catra, "Did you really have to rile her up like that?"

Shit. Catra really fucked this one up, didn't she?

"I'm sorry," Catra said, and she meant it, "I just hated how she was talking about us. About *you.* "

"Can you blame her?"

Catra sighed, leaning against the table, "I guess not, but that doesn't mean I want you to blame me."

Adora softened a bit, "I didn't mean-"

“I know,” Catra assured quickly, not wanting Adora to think she’s angry with her,“This is important to you, I get it. But this is gonna be a lot harder than you want to admit. They won’t trust us on our word alone.”

“Then what do we do?” Adora asked hopelessly.

“First things first,” Catra hummed, caressing Adora’s cheek with her hand and leaning in close, “We’re gonna enjoy the party.”

“But-”

“No buts, princess,” Catra chided softly, poking her lip with the tip of her finger to elicit a small smile, “I was promised a date, was I not?”

“We still don’t really know what that entails,” Adora commented, but she was finally smiling and that’s honestly all that mattered to Catra.

“We’ll figure it out,” Catra said breezily before sobering up slightly and intertwining their fingers, “And then we’ll talk to them again. And you can finally give them your dumb ‘let’s be friends’ speech, alright?”

“You really know how to romance a girl,” Adora replied sarcastically, her eyes sparkling with amusement, “Really feeling the love right now.”

Catra pressed a chaste kiss to her lips, “Hush, we have disgusting couple-y shit to do.”

“Oh, yeah?” It sounded almost like a challenge. Catra felt Adora’s hands wrap around her waist, pulling her closer. Catra could feel her fingers dancing along the exposed skin of her midriff.

Catra pulled her the rest of the way, kissing her deeply and wrapping her arms around Adora's neck to get the best angle - her fingers wove themselves in her hair, tousling the soft waves that she'd been dying to mess up from the moment Adora had stepped out of the bathroom in their shared room.

Adora's hand snaked further up her stomach while the other trailed up her arm. Adora hummed into the kiss, pulling back for a moment, much to Catra's dismay.

"You're cold."

"Baby, we're surrounded by *ice* ," Catra murmured against her lips, trying to catch them in her own once more, "Of course, I'm cold."

Adora moved further back and Catra audibly groaned. But her frustration faded quickly as she watched Adora slide off her jacket, exposing the delicious black dress underneath.

Adora ignored Catra's blatant checking out and gently draped the jacket over her shoulders - the warmth felt heavenly compared to the chill that had been seeping into her bones. Catra remained still as Adora fussed over her, soft fingers pushing hair from her face and carefully freeing any pieces that got trapped under the jacket's collar.

Catra's cheeks felt hot as Adora's fingers traced over them, her free hand moving down her arm to take Catra's hand in her own.

Adora didn't take her eyes off Catra as she lifted her hand to her lips, grazing Catra's knuckles with a featherlight kiss.

"How's that?" Adora asked with a slight smirk, like she knew damn well what effect she was having on her girlfriend.

Catra swallowed hard, her words coming out breathless and wanting, "Absolutely nauseating."

Adora grinned, turning around but keeping her hand firmly in Catra's as she tugged her along, "Oh, you'll hate what's next then."

"And what's that?"

Adora led her to the middle of the ballroom, where groups of people were coming together as Frosta spoke a quick announcement.

" *It is my solemn duty as hostess to now announce,"* Frosta paused, looking out at the figures amassing on the floor, *"it is time for the first dance of the Ball."*

Adora pulled Catra in, draping her hands across Catra's waist once more as she urged Catra's own to rest at the nape of her neck.

"Dance with me."



Glimmer frowned, watching Bow pull Perfuma onto the dance floor as the music began. It was bad enough the Ball was crawling with enemy soldiers, now she wouldn't even get a dance with her own best friend?

Maybe it was petty and maybe she was bitter, but Glimmer couldn't understand how things could go so wrong. Things would be so much easier if Perfuma had just never asked Bow in the first place. Couldn't she have *one* person be just hers? Hadn't she earned the right to be someone's priority?

Her father was gone, her mother had a whole kingdom to protect, and the princesses they'd managed to acquire for the alliance were mere strangers to her. Bow had been *hers* . Her

person. Her *only* friend. Now he'd ditched her for another princess whom he barely knew. Didn't he *want* to be her friend anymore?

Glimmer sniffled and reminded herself of her mission. She looked away from Bow and the pain it brought and refocused on the Horde Lord. She was an easy enough target, swaying to the music in the middle of the floor with her girlfriend in her arms. Glimmer could keep an eye on them from where she was - she wouldn't have to delve into the mass of people that thought nothing of her. She didn't *need* someone to dance with or to hold her. Glimmer had a *mission.* That's all that mattered now.

Bile rose in her throat as she watched the pair dance - Adora whispering something in her lover's ear, Catra burying a laugh into Adora's shoulder. The pair looked at eachother like no one else was there, like words weren't even necessary - one look in each other's eyes and they could know exactly what the other was thinking.

Glimmer had something like that with Bow - a testament to the time they'd spend together. To how well they'd known each other. Glimmer had thought they knew each other in ways no one else would. Could Perfuma read his thoughts the way Glimmer could? Would Bow attach notes to his arrows and send them through Perfuma's window just to talk to her? Would they go on adventures together like her and Bow had always dreamed of?

Glimmer smacked her fist against the railing, squeezing her eyes shut to stop the oncoming tears. She needed to *focus*.

But Glimmer deflated even more when she looked back at the Horde duo swaying peacefully as ever. They hadn't shown a hint of ulterior motive since they arrived and Glimmer hated them more for it.

It wasn't *fair.* The way they laughed and kissed and swayed while Glimmer stood alone. She'd spent ages trying to prove herself and stop the Horde from hurting more people and yet her one chance to take them out for good had to be thwarted by the soldiers in question shoving their happiness in her face and playing innocent.

A voice in the back of her mind told her that innocent might be exactly what they are - Glimmer refused to listen to it. How could *anyone* from the Horde be good? It doesn't matter what Adora had claimed, Glimmer would be a fool to fall for pretty words and kind faces.

Finally, Glimmer looked away. She needed air, needed to be able to *think* . She left the dance floor behind, stepping just outside the ballroom doors to pull herself together.

It was only a few moments before a shadow crossed over her, Glimmer looked up - her breath catching when she found Scorpia standing over her. She clenched her fists at her side, preparing to fight her way out.

“You okay?”

Glimmer blinked, “…what?”

“Are you okay?” Scorpia tilted her head, “You look a little- yknow…sad.”

Glimmer turned away, “I don’t need *pity.* Least of all from you.”

Scorpia sighed, “I get it. You don’t trust me. I don’t blame you - I haven’t fit in with the princesses in a long time. I never really did.”

Glimmer scoffed, “Because your family joined the *Horde* .”

“Maybe,” Scorpia moved to stand beside her, “I’m just saying-…don’t lose what you have, y’know? I’d do just about anything to have a friend like yours.”

“I don’t wanna talk about him.”

“He cares about you,” Scorpia assured.

“If he did, wouldn’t he be here right now instead of you?” Glimmer said, hating how sad and weak she sounded even to her own ears.

“How can he be if you haven’t told him how you feel?” Scorpia asked and Glimmer supposed she had to give her that much, “Everyone has a person. You have Bow. Adora and Catra have eachother. Don’t lose it.”

A tear fell down Glimmer’s cheek. Scorpia lifted a pincer to wipe it away. Glimmer didn’t flinch, though she was surprised by how gentle the action was.

“Why do you care?”

Scorpia shrugged, looking through the open doors into the party, “I know what it’s like to feel like you don’t belong. I just wanted you to know that you have someone in your corner - even if you hate me.”

“So- this…this isn’t some trick?” Glimmer felt foolish for asking, but considering everything she knew of Horde soldiers, she felt justified in her caution thus far, “You’re not just- I don’t know, trying to get my guard down? Make it easier for your friends to ambush me?”

Scorpia smiled at that. “I haven’t known Adora long, but if there’s one thing I know about her…it’s that she’s honest.” Scorpia laid a pincer on Glimmer’s shoulder. “She doesn’t want to hurt anyone. The Horde’s caused a lot of pain in Etheria, but it also did quite a number on the rest of us. We don’t want it to go on like this.”

Glimmer could see the honesty in her eyes. Even as every fiber of Glimmer’s being wanted to reject it - to fight, to not fall for a trap her mind told her was imminent. Scorpia had every opportunity to hurt Glimmer. They were away from the party and Glimmer was certainly vulnerable enough.

Instead, Scorpia had not only comforted her, but vouched for her friends. In another life, it was the type of gesture that would have made Glimmer keen on becoming the princess’ friend.

Despite it all, Glimmer couldn't help but wonder if there was still a chance they could be.

Glimmer had spent her entire life trying to prove herself. Now, she realized she wasn't the only one who deserved a chance to show who they truly were.

Glimmer swallowed, her conviction strengthening as she turned to look at Scorpia head on.

"Let's go inside."



"Can you two do that somewhere else?"

Catra rolled her eyes, but didn't remove her hands from where they'd settled on Adora's muscles, "Jealous that your date ditched you, Lon?"

Lonnie rolled her eyes, "Scorpia went to talk to the princess you pissed off."

"She *what* ?" Adora said worriedly, glancing behind her to try and catch sight of their scorpioni friend.

"I'm sure she's fine," Catra nuzzled further into Adora, partly because she wanted to but mostly to piss off Lonnie some more.

"There she is," Lonnie pointed to where Scorpia had appeared at the ballroom entrance, but not before shooting Catra a death glare.

“See? She’s fine,” Catra told Adora, “Not a scratch on her and she’s-…with the annoying princess.”

Catra watched, eyebrows reaching her hairline, as Scorpia approached them with Glimmer matching up beside her.

“Scorpia, what the fuck?”

“We came to an agreement!” Scorpia said cheerfully.

“An understanding,” Glimmer corrected, glancing between them all suspiciously, “But it doesn’t mean I *trust* you.”

“I don’t give a shit if you trust me-”

“ *Catra!”* Lonnie and Adora chorused.

“-As long as you trust *Adora* ,” Catra finished pointedly, glaring at her girlfriend, “What, no faith in me?”

“Hey, Lonnie did it too!” Adora defended, “Why aren’t you scolding her?”

“Don’t bring me into this.”

“I expect it from Lonnie,” Catra huffed a tad dramatically, draping her hand over her forehead, “And after all I’ve done for you.”

“Oh, like *what* ?”

Catra turned a devilish smirk her way, raising an eyebrow almost like a taunt as she opened her mouth to reply.

“Nevermind, shut up,” Adora said quickly.

Glimmer spoke up before Catra could retort.

“Maybe I was wrong about you guys,” They all turned to her with surprised expressions, “You two are too damn sappy to be evil.”

“I’m offended you think I can’t do both,” Catra winked.

“Does she have to be here for this?” Glimmer groaned.

“And what is *this* exactly?” Adora asked almost hopefully.

Glimmer sighed, looking at the ground, “I might possibly be *considering* some negotiations.”

“ *Yes!* ”

The exclamation from her girlfriend was paired with an utterly ridiculous fist bump, but it was just cute enough that Catra let her get away with it.

“I’m not promising anything,” Glimmer said sternly, though Catra could swear her mouth quirked up in amusement, “But I’ll consider asking my mom about a meeting.”

“Shouldn’t the boy be here for this?” Catra asked idly.

“The boy?” Glimmer repeated slowly.

Catra waved a dismissive hand even as Adora chuckled, “Crop top guy. Arrows, is it?”

“ *Bow.”*

“That’s what I said.”

“It’s really not-”

“Whatever. Is he with you or not?”

Glimmer frowned, “Right now he’s with *Perfuma.* ”

The bitterness - and sadness - in her voice was unmistakable. Catra felt her stomach twist at the reminder that she’d been a lot like that before Adora and her had figured out their shit.

“Are you sure?” Catra mused, “Because he keeps glancing over here.”

Glimmer’s head snapped up, “He is?”

Catra held up a finger before focusing her gaze on Bow.

“Arrow Boy!” She called, “Get your ass over here!”

Glimmer spluttered protests while Adora facepalmed.

“What? I’m helping!”

“Aww, going soft, Wildcat?” Scorpia grinned.

Catra leveled a finger at her, “I will *end* you.”

Adora cleared her throat, not so casually wrapping an arm around Catra and pulling her in, “Let’s get back to business, shall we?”

“What’s going on?” Bow asked, placing himself next to Glimmer with an eyebrow raised pointedly in Catra’s direction.

Catra turned to her girlfriend, smiling innocently, “Is it time for the ‘let’s be friends’ speech?”

“It’s time for you to *shut up* ,” Adora retorted, squeezing her waist.

“Hot.”

Lonnie cleared her throat, muttering something that sounded suspiciously like ‘get a room’.

Bow looked at them skeptically and turned to Glimmer, “Is everything okay?”

Glimmer looked at him for a long time, almost like she was drinking him in. Catra - for a moment - imagined she looked quite similar whenever she saw Adora. Then she abandoned the thought after realizing how *sappy* it was.

“Yeah,” Glimmer nodded and it felt like she was talking about more than their current situation, but Catra couldn’t imagine what. Glimmer smiled, “Everything’s fine. We were-well…negotiating?”

“If you call watching these two idiots flirt ‘negotiations’,” Lonnie drawled.

Catra let out a soft hiss in Lonnie’s direction before returning her focus to the topic at hand, “Sparkles was saying something about a meeting?”

“ *Glimmer* ,” She corrected with a glare, “And it’s gonna talk a lot more than a few *meetings* to undo years of war. For all we know, Hordak’s puppeteering you both for something worse.”

“We don’t trust eachother, that much is obvious,” Adora said diplomatically, “But you can trust me when I say that Hordak is rotting in a cell - exactly where he belongs.”

“He should be brought to justice,” Glimmer said firmly, “The Rebellion should have a say in his fate.”

“Glimmer’s right,” Bow added, “He’s caused us all pain, that’s for sure. But he needs to answer for his crimes against Etheria.”

Adora raised her head, considering them both. Catra could practically see the gears turning in her head. Slowly, Adora smirked.

“I think there’s something I can do.”

Glimmer and Bow seemed slightly put off by the mischief in Adora’s eyes, but Catra felt quite the opposite.

Catra purred, intrigued by Adora’s mysterious answer, “I think I’m gonna like this plan.”

Adora chuckled, pressing a kiss to Catra's hand the same way she'd done earlier. Slowly, she turned back to the rebels.

"I'll see about setting up a meeting soon," Adora said in a formal, somewhat authoritative tone, "We should be going now."

"And we're just supposed to trust your word?" Glimmer called after her.

Adora turned ever so slightly, her eyes glittering, "Don't worry, you'll have your show of good faith soon enough."

Adora turned her gaze to Catra as their rebel 'friends' mulled over her words. She lifted a hand out for Catra, taking Catra's hand in a loose grip and leading her outside as Scorpia and Lonnie trailed behind.

As their skiff flew through the Kingdom of Snows, headed towards home, Catra looped her arms around Adora's neck, breathing her in.

"So," Catra hummed, trailing a finger down Adora's cheek, "What's your plan?"

"You'll see," Adora replied cheekily, distracting Catra from her interrogation with lazy kisses along her jaw and neck.

Catra scoffed, but leaned her head bad nonetheless, "You're evil. How you've convinced anyone otherwise is a miracle."

Adora huffed out a laugh against her skin, "That so?"

Catra nodded, letting out an almost strangled hum, “Yep. You’re no good. Positively *corrupt* , actually.”

“What can I say?” Adora halted her kisses, her hands moving to tug Catra closer by the collar of the jacket still wrapped around her shoulders.

Adora’s eyes were dark as they roved over Catra’s face, memorizing every detail in the fading light of the moon. She lifted Catra’s chin with a single finger, her smile absolutely *wicked.*

“I learned from the best.”



Adora’s show of faith came two weeks later on what Glimmer would have considered a normal day in Brightmoon.

Adora’s promise had nearly faded to the edges of her mind, self doubt having creeped in when a week came and went. Any thought of an allying with the Horde Lord had made way to guilt for falling for a clear trick.

That is, until Glimmer heard the commotion outside.

She grabbed hold of Bow and teleported to the castle entrance, where guards had amassed alongside Glimmer’s mother.

Glimmer feared the worst as she and Bow pushed past the guards to reach Angella. Was the Horde attacking? Had Glimmer’s false hope doomed them all?

“Mom! What’s going-”

Glimmer's mouth snapped shut as she took in the scene before her.

The former Lord Hordak himself was at the base of the stairs. Chains were secured around his entire body, along with cuffs that kept his hands trapped behind his back.

That sight alone was enough to make Glimmer think she was losing her mind, but it didn't end there.

Because atop Hordak's head sat a bright red bow - one you'd expect to see atop a gift box. Another ribbon was lodged inside his mouth, serving as a gag and muffling what Glimmer was certain was a stream of swears.

Glimmer stepped forward almost unconsciously when she saw something else. Her mother threw out a hand to stop her.

"Glimmer, don't-"

"It's fine, mom," Glimmer assured, briefly taking her moms hand, "I'll teleport away if he tries anything."

Angella clearly did not approve, but she knew Glimmer well enough to know she'd do it regardless of Angella's approval.

Slowly, Glimmer crept forward until she was standing in front of Lord Hordak himself - the man who had devastated the land of Etheria for over a decade.

On his knees, wrapped in chains and ribbon.

Glimmer could say with absolute certainty that she didn't find him so scary now.

With that in mind, she took a final step forward and plucked the note from where it had been taped to his forehead.

Glimmer read the short note with growing incredulity, letting out an uncharacteristic laugh before finally stepping aside and allowing the guards to drag Hordak away.

And as everyone retreated into the castle, Glimmer looked out into the horizon. Past the moonstone tower and past the villages and meadows surrounding it.

Glimmer stared into the Whispering Woods and allowed herself to wonder who was staring back.

“Alright,” she called out into the empty sky, “You held up your end. I’ll hold up mine.”

She couldn’t be sure anyone was listening, but Glimmer decided it didn’t matter. They would know, regardless of if they were here to witness her promise - they would know.



He’s all yours.

See you soon.

- A

End Notes

literally everyone in this fic: um can yall not

catra, literally sitting on adora: we arent doing anything

like girls pls this is a public space

title is from personal cathedrals by Aly&AJ go check out their music or else!!!

glimmer pov was def new for me but im blown away by how similar she is to catra ND was not kidding about them mirroring eachother

i feel like adoras main motivation for doing that to hordak was just "oh this will be HILARIOUS" and i respect that. be gay do crime or whateva

i commissioned some artwork for this au from the incredible RinniiArt on twitter/tumblr!

link to her profile right here: RinniiArt

the art (and a link to this fic) will also be pinned on my profile: wronghuntress

thank you for reading!!! <33333

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!